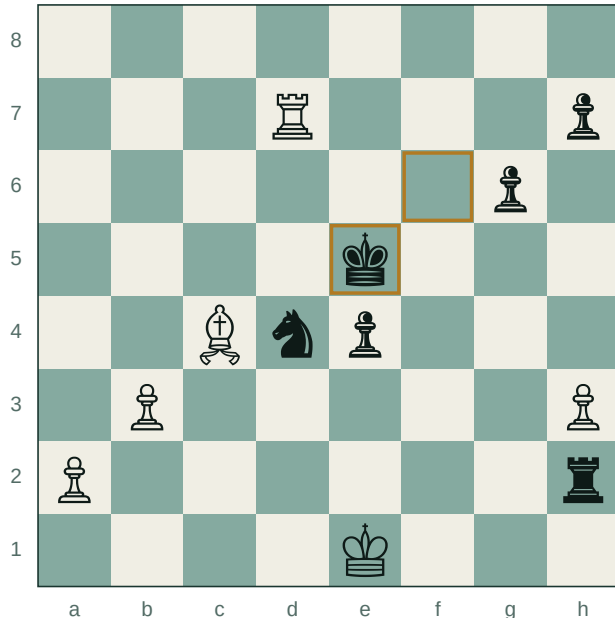


Deflection tactics: White, move 41

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 40...Ke5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

41. Rd5+ Kf4 42. Rxd4

41.Rd5+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. From d5 it attacks king on e5 and knight on d4. Recorded reply: **41...Kf4**.

42.Rxd4 The rook captures the knight on d4.

At the end, nominal material is White 11 / Black 8 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on e5. Geometrically undefended: rook on h2. Check for tactical protection.